

I Poster Gallery

A choice-driven session: participants browse the ten commandments, claim the one that speaks to them, and teach it back to the group.

AUDIENCE

Teens (middle school and up). Adults joining as participants can use the same questions as written.

GROUP SIZE

Fifteen to sixty participants.

ROOM

Wall space for ten posters, spread out, plus enough floor area for pairs to sit and talk near their poster. Space matters more than seating.

STAFFING

One facilitator, plus roughly one circulating staff member or assistant per fifteen participants. Brief them beforehand: their job during chevrotah time is to move, listen, and nudge conversations back on topic.

Materials

- ☐ Ten commandment posters, hung around the room in advance with space between them
- ☐ Camper handouts, one per person or per pair (the chevrotah questions are on the last page)
- ☐ Scenario cards, cut apart
- ☐ Pens and participant feedback slips (60 and 90 minute versions)

Timing

This program can be adapted based on time available.

Segment	45 min	60 min	90 min
1. Welcome and framing	5	5	10
2. Gallery walk: browse and choose	10	10	15
3. Chevrotah at the posters	10	15	20
4. Full-group share	10	15	20
5. Scenario cards	10	10	15
6. Research moment	—	5	5
7. Closing and feedback	—	—	5
Total	45	60	90

Pick your column and follow it top to bottom; each column adds up on its own. Segments 6 and 7 are fully written out below, so nothing new is needed to run the longer versions.

Running the Session

1. Welcome and Framing (5/5/10 min)

Welcome everyone and name what this is: a set of ten commandments for how we treat each other online, built from Jewish values and from research on what teens actually experience. Open with the most famous one-line summary of Torah our tradition has:

SUGGESTED FRAMING

Two thousand years ago, someone challenged Hillel to teach the entire Torah while standing on one foot. He answered: "What is hateful to you, do not do to others. That is the whole Torah; the rest is commentary. Go and learn it." (*Talmud Shabbat 31a*) Tonight we are doing the "go and learn it" part, and asking what Hillel's rule looks like on a screen.

Let them know this document is a living draft: their reactions and pushback tonight will shape the next version. That is not a disclaimer; it is an invitation.

2. Gallery Walk: Browse and Choose (10/10/15 min)

Invite participants to wander the room and read the posters, then stand by the commandment that sparks something for them: interest, agreement, or even disagreement. Disagreement makes for the best conversations.

FIELD NOTE

Expect an uneven spread, and let it be. Choice and ownership over the topic are worth more than balanced coverage. If one poster draws a crowd, split it into several pairs. If a commandment gets no takers, save it: that gap becomes a great full-group question later ("Why do you think nobody picked this one?").

3. Chevrutah at the Posters (10/15/20 min)

Have participants pair up where they stand (friends pairing up is fine; a few groups of three is fine). Each pair sits near its poster so they can refer to it, reads their commandment together from the handout, and works through the questions on the last page of the handout:

Chevrutah Questions

1. Read your commandment aloud together, including the Jewish value and the "What Teens Are Saying" section.
2. Does this feel realistic for people your age? Why or why not?
3. Where have you seen this play out, online or in person?
4. What would you add, change, or push back on?
5. Choose one idea or takeaway to share with the group.

IF A PAIR FINISHES EARLY OR DRIFTS OFF TOPIC

Send them to a second poster with one question: "Do your two commandments ever conflict with each other?" (For example, Seek Truth and Guard Your Tongue: when might honesty and restraint pull in opposite directions?) This is also where circulating staff earn their keep; a quiet staff presence nearby keeps conversations real.

4. Full-Group Share (10/15/20 min)

Gather everyone back. Start with volunteers: "Who had a conversation worth sharing?" When the volunteers run dry, do not wait out the silence; switch to a friendly roll call by commandment: "Who chose number one? Want to share? Number two?" This keeps momentum and makes sure every commandment that was chosen gets a voice.

If a commandment went unchosen, name it yourself in one sentence and ask the group why they think it got passed over.

5. Scenario Cards (10/10/15 min)

Ask for volunteers to each take a scenario card, read it aloud, and offer their own thoughts first: which commandments apply, and what would they do? Then open it to the room.

DEPTH OVER COVERAGE

You will not get through all ten cards, and you should not try. One scenario that catches fire is worth more than five read in a rush. In the first field test, two cards filled ten minutes with the strongest conversation of the night. When a conversation is working, stay in it.

6. Research Moment (–/5/5 min)

Take five minutes to mention the research and impact of these technologies. Participants consistently want to know more about what all this is doing to them, so tell them, and tell them where it comes from:

SUGGESTED SCRIPT

"Every commandment you studied tonight has a section called What Teens Are Saying. Those are not decorations; they are real studies of thousands of teens. A couple worth knowing: almost half of teens say social media has a negative impact on people their age, and teens themselves draw a line with AI: most say using it for research is fine, but fewer than one in five say the same about having it write your essay. The research is in your hands in this handout. Take it seriously; it is about you."

7. Closing and Feedback (–/–/5 min)

Hand out participant feedback slips and give everyone three quiet minutes to fill them out. Collect them before anyone leaves; slips that go home do not come back. Close with:

"In a place where there are no human beings, strive to be a human being." (*Pirkei Avot 2:5*) Online is often a place where it feels like there are no human beings. Strive to be one.

In the 45 and 60 minute versions, skip the written feedback for participants and instead fill out the facilitator feedback form yourself as soon as possible after the session, while it is fresh.

Facilitation Notes

- **The room is part of the program.** The single biggest lesson from the first field test: a cramped room works against you. Pairs need enough distance from each other to hear themselves talk.
- **Brief your staff.** One engaged, circulating adult is worth three standing at the back. Tell staff in advance exactly what their role is during chevrotah time.
- **Adults in the room.** If adults participate alongside teens, they use the same questions and answer for themselves, not about "kids these days."